

TEQUILA ACCELERATOR

A phased, institutionally supported pathway for Mexican tequila brands to enter and expand within India's premium beverages market—preserving authenticity, ensuring compliance, and building sustainable distribution partnerships.

PROGRAM OBJECTIVE

The Tequila Accelerator provides Mexican tequila brands with a **structured, compliant, and institutionally supported pathway** to enter and expand within India's premium beverages market, while preserving authenticity, quality, and Denomination of Origin standards.

Week 1-2

Phase 1: India Opportunity & Product Readiness Assessment

Evaluating brand readiness for the Indian market and identifying gaps, risks, and opportunities

- Structured readiness assessment through detailed questionnaires
- Identification of regulatory, commercial, and operational challenges
- Virtual session: "India Opportunity Briefing" covering market size, consumer segments, and positioning opportunities
- Gap analysis and program customization

Week 3-4

Phase 2: India Compliance & Market Navigation Framework

Addressing India's complex alcohol regulatory framework and market-entry requirements

- Guidance on licensing and state-level excise regulations (FL-I requirements)
- Label compliance and statutory declarations (Standards & Weight Measures Act)
- Import documentation and customs procedures
- Coordination with excise authorities and customs brokers
- Cultural and business practice orientation for India market

Week 4-5

Phase 3: Financial Readiness & Market Positioning

Preparing brands for commercial engagement and strategic positioning in India

- Financial readiness and pricing strategy assessment (landed costs, MRP calculation)
- Market positioning and brand narrative development for Indian consumers
- Advisory on route-to-market strategies (direct import, distributor partnerships, etc.)
- Brand representation and visibility planning
- Competitive differentiation strategy

Week 6-8

Phase 4: Trade Mission & Buyer Engagement

Direct commercial engagement between Mexican producers and Indian buyers

- **Virtual Tequila Trade Mission** to India with curated buyer introductions
- Facilitated meetings with leading Indian importers and distributors
- **Tequila Tasting & Buyer Engagement Session** hosted at Consulate General of México, Mumbai
- Premium brand showcase directly by producers to trade audience
- Partnership negotiation support and contract guidance

Post-Program Advisory Support (2 Months)

Continued guidance following the initial accelerator phase for brands requiring ongoing market development support

- ▶ Ongoing market intelligence and buyer insights
- ▶ Regulatory and excise policy updates
- ▶ Expansion planning and follow-up with distributors
- ▶ Support for scaling presence within the Indian market

Program Enrolment

Mexican tequila brands interested in participating in the Tequila Accelerator should submit an Expression of Interest to the Council. Program participation is by application and subject to brand qualification.
MÉXICO—INDIA BUSINESS COUNCIL

CONTACT

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